

Consulting quality gates

Five control points that turn emerging analysis into trusted client advice.

AUDIENCE	All Summit Vale Advisory delivery teams
PURPOSE	Provide consistent, lightweight review gates without slowing useful work.
VERSION	1.0 As of 13 Jul 2026
OWNER	Nina Solberg Quality Assurance

The five gates

Frame: Is the question decision-shaped? Evidence: Are sources sufficient and traceable? Analysis: Are methods and calculations reproducible? Narrative: Does the storyline answer the question? Release: Is the artifact accurate, audience-fit and approved?

Operating rhythm

- Run a 20-minute Frame review before data requests.
- Schedule Evidence and Analysis checks at the midpoint.
- Hold a Narrative review before design polish.
- Use Release review for decisions, factual claims and client distribution.

Control record: minimum evidence for a review

Control point	Evidence to retain	Decision rule
Scope	Decision statement and named audience	Proceed only when scope is bounded.
Evidence	Source/assumption log and review notes	Separate verified facts from estimates.
Action	Owner, timing and next review date	Assign one accountable owner.

Application notes

Worked example: Client Alpha

Synthetic example data. At the Evidence gate, the team records the approved Phase 1 Finance diagnostic budget as JPY 42.8M, marks finance controller confirmation as pending, and prevents any spend projection from being presented as an approved fact.

Escalation rules

Escalate to the engagement lead if evidence conflicts, the client request changes materially, a deadline prevents review, or access classification is unclear. The lead may accept a documented risk; they may not silently waive it.

Decision worksheet

Control point	Evidence to retain	Decision rule
Scope	Decision statement and named audience	Proceed only when scope is bounded.
Evidence	Source/assumption log and review notes	Separate verified facts from estimates.
Action	Owner, timing and next review date	Assign one accountable owner.

Practice note. Use concise records that make the next decision easier. This guide is an internal operating reference; it is not a substitute for engagement-specific governance.

Execution and review

Gate record

Record date, reviewer, decision, exceptions, corrective action and owner in the engagement workspace. A short record makes later challenge constructive rather than forensic.

Practical checklist

- Confirm the purpose and audience before working from the guide.
- Maintain clear distinction between verified facts, assumptions and synthetic examples.
- Record accountable owner, next step and decision date.
- Invite an independent reviewer when conclusions or access risks are material.
- Update the engagement record after the decision is made.

Sign-off prompts

Control point	Evidence to retain	Decision rule
Scope	Decision statement and named audience	Proceed only when scope is bounded.
Evidence	Source/assumption log and review notes	Separate verified facts from estimates.
Action	Owner, timing and next review date	Assign one accountable owner.

Summit Vale Advisory | Internal reference guide | As of 13 Jul 2026 | Owner: Avery Calder, Engagement Excellence